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SOUMYA CHAVA

Executive Director— Affordable Medicines, Laurus Labs

BEST MANAGEMENT ADVICE RECEIVED

In business, indecision can often be more damaging than making the wrong decision

Molecules of Ambition

Soumya Chava of Laurus Labs is targeting growth in finished-dose drugs and contract manufacturing across global markets

BY **NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA**

LAURUS LABS IS looking to expand its finished-dose medicines business and contract manufacturing operations as Soumya Chava leads growth plans for its affordable medicines division. The focus is on increasing the contribution of formulations alongside the company's established active pharmaceutical ingredients (API) business and expanding its reach.

Chava, Executive Director, Affordable Medicines, is the daughter of the Founder and CEO of Laurus Labs, Satyanarayana Chava. She oversees the company's global generics business and customer partnerships.

Laurus Labs reported revenue of ₹6,813 crore in FY26, up 23% year-on-year. EBITDA (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortisation) rose 64% to ₹1,826 crore, while profit after tax stood at ₹889 crore.

Over the next 12–18 months, Chava says the focus will be on expanding the formulations portfolio, improving market access, and increasing contract manufacturing opportunities.

"In affordable medicines, we will continue to expand formulations, improve market access, strengthen our API business, and grow contract manufacturing opportunities," she says.

The company is also investing in manufacturing capabilities in newer areas. These include a microbial fermentation facility in Visakhapatnam, investments in gene therapy, and antibody-drug conjugate-related capabilities in Hyderabad. These projects will broaden the range of manufacturing technologies available to the company.

Laurus Labs is deploying digital tools and automation to improve plant productivity as operations expand. BT

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NOTE *The rank is based on* BT*'s proprietary methodology involving profit after tax, profit growth, and operating profit margin, focusing on profitability as the key metric to judge performance*